

friends of Lenzie Moss

ROUND-UP OF ACTIVITIES IN 2025-2026

PRESENTATIONS

In May 2025, we gave a slide presentation to the 1st Lenzie Scouts on the Scottish Outdoor Access Code. The scouts had been studying SOAC and wanted to understand how to interpret this in practice when visiting Lenzie Moss..... >>>>>

.....**and in March 2026**, we gave a slide presentation to the Society of Antiquarians in Kirkintilloch on the history of Lenzie Moss and the role of FoLM in helping to conserve it.



CONSERVATION VOLUNTEERS

The committee have continued to liaise with EDC to establish a regular programme of conservation work on the Moss for our volunteers. The volunteers had an outing on 29 November taking on tree trimming; repair of informal “dead hedges”; general tidying up; and creating new “dead hedges” to protect informal paths in the north woods from over usage.

Two of our own priorities are to provide additional seats for visitors round the circular path, and to repair part of the bench located near the site of the storm-damaged whitebeam tree. We are liaising with EDC to have these done.



Dead hedging



Broken seat

EDC'S ONGOING CONSERVATION WORKS

You'll no doubt be aware of EDC's ongoing conservation works on the Moss, and their signage explaining what's being done to protect the Moss's terrain and wildlife. This has not always gone down well with visitors, who are used to being able to walk over the Moss along informal paths, very often taking their dogs for a walk. All understandable. However, considerable damage is being done to the Moss by ignoring the requests to stay away from sensitive areas and by vandalising the works and signage.

Two important issues the works seek to address are protecting the fossorial water voles now established on the Moss - a protected species under the Wildlife & Countryside Act 1981; and the re-wetting of the open bog under Scotland's National Peatland Plan. Both of these need us to exercise care not to damage the voles' habitat, and not to damage the peat itself.

Other works include creating pools for wildlife; repairs to some of the dams; lowering one of the main dams to release water into one of the drainage ditches in accordance with the recent Hydrological Study. Repairs to the boardwalk have also been carried out, and the new boardwalk seat will be installed along with new edging boards.



Footfall damage to the peat



Thanks to Sally Grosart for this recent photo of one of the fossorial water voles emerging from its burrow

EVENTS ON THE MOSS 2026

We are now pleased to have a dedicated group of members to organise events on the Moss. The group has had one meeting and we're following this up with event providers to arrange events for 2026.

100 CIRCLES

We continue to be interested in a project of one of our members, 100 CIRCLES, part of an art-science collaboration with Edinburgh University. The project consists of 100 walks round Lenzie Moss in conversation with various individuals. You can read these on-line at "100 circles blog" (Edinburgh University).

WEBSITE

We decided to refresh our website this year and make it easier to update, and one of our members very kindly volunteered to do this for us. We hope you have had chance to look at it. It's not yet complete but work continues on updating all the pages. Our thanks go to Martina for all her work on this.



Finally, thank you to all our members for your continuing support.